



Agenda - Deliberation on strengthening access to justice, promoting inclusive legal systems, eliminating discriminatory laws and practices with special emphasis on structural barriers (CSW 70)

Letter from the Executive Board

Greetings Delegates, we are extremely excited to welcome you to this mock committee - UNCSW at the first edition of Resolve MUN 2026. It is our pleasure to serve as your Executive Board for this conference. This background guide will give you insight on the agenda and will serve as a base for your research.

Please read through it carefully and research more on where the problem arises. You can contact the Executive Board at all and any points of this conference for any clarification. Do understand that this Background Guide is in no way exhaustive and is only meant to provide you with enough background information to establish a platform for beginning the research.

Delegates are highly recommended to do a good amount of research beyond what is covered in the Guide.

A delegate is not defined by experience but by their ability to be a civil diplomat respecting others opinions, following foreign policy while actively taking part in committee. Your ability to provide solutions and valid points with credential sources will give you the upper hand throughout the conference.

We look forward to a fruitful discussion and an enriching experience with all of you.

Regards,

Chair - Sankalp Chouhan

Vice Chair - Rohan Siddharth

Vice Chair - Harshitha Andra

HOW TO RESEARCH?

1. The most basic thing to do in a **Model UN** is to research, speak, and rebuttal.
2. Do a basic **PESTEL** analysis of your country, which is connected with the agenda.
3. Prepare around **2 to 3 speeches** for the **General Speakers' List (GSL)**. Such speeches are generally **60 - 90 seconds long**. Their length should never exceed more than **200 words**.
4. Always give your remaining time to questions while ensuring that you try to get more speaking time from others through something called **“yields”**.
5. Prepare a list of at least **3 subtopics**. Have a **60-second** speech ready for each mentally.
6. It's crucial that you listen to the speeches of **other delegates**. This helps you find questions and rebuttal points for future speeches. **More than research, questions involve logic**.
7. Have some solutions ready beforehand in an **“Operative Clause”** format. Solutions in a MUN follow a **very legal and diplomatic language**, which can be noticed in the past **UN documents and resolutions**. Refer to the following link - bestdelegate.com

RESEARCHING METHODOLOGY

The Executive Board highly encourages the use of the following research methodologies in your speeches:

- 1) **IRAC**: Issue, Rule, Application, and Conclusion

Issue: Identify the core problem of the agenda being debated. To make the debate more structured. Do mention the problems in your countries as well.

Rule: Bring in relevant international laws, treaties, or **UN resolutions** to support the agenda

Application: Analyze how this law applies to the specific country you're representing.

E.g., *"While Germany supports online freedom, it also enforces the Network Enforcement Act to combat hate speech, creating a balance between rights and regulation."*

Conclusion: End with a clear position or solution.

E.g., "Thus, Germany believes that regulation is necessary but must remain within the bounds of international human rights law."

2) PESTLE: Political, Economic, Sociological, Technological, Legal, and Environmental

Letter	Stands For	What to Research
P	Political	Government type, political stability, alliances, foreign policy, stance on UN issues
E	Economic	GDP, development level, trade, inflation, funding capacity for programs
S	Social	Religion, culture, education, public awareness, gender roles, and civil society

T	Technological	Innovation, cyber capabilities, internet access, and digital censorship
L	Legal	Laws (national/international), treaties signed, human rights records
E	Environmental	Natural resources, climate change, disasters, and sustainability policies

Techniques to Write Good Speeches

1. HPA Method - Hook, Point, Action

How to Write an Opening Speech - Best Delegate Model United Nations

2. LEET Method - Label, Explain, Example, Tieback

Example of LEET

3. FLL Approach - Fact, Legality, and Logic

This is a very technical and substantive approach to certain subtopics. You need to analyze the facts of the situation along with the legal realities surrounding it. Then one needs to connect both the facts and legalities through logic to weave a story and frame a narrative that they wish to portray to the public/audience.

4. PEN Method - Punchline, Example, Nail in the Coffin

This is a more aggressive style of debate, which is relevant for defensive arguments or rebuttals to allegations. One can start with a “punchline” which is generally the main observation or summary of the speech delivered in a humorous, satirical, aggressive, or fairly dramatic fashion. One needs to back such an observation with substantive arguments, examples, or legal references. Then, similar to a Tieback, you need to put the nail in the coffin with a concluding statement to remind the audience why you believe your particular interpretation of the subject matter is the right one.

“A good speaker is not one who only knows how to start it well, but to also end it well.”

IMPORTANT POINTS TO REMEMBER

A few aspects that delegates should keep in mind while preparing:

1. Procedure: The purpose of putting in procedural rules in any committee is to ensure a more organized and efficient debate. The committee will follow the **UNA-USA Rules of Procedure**. Although the Executive Board shall be fairly strict with the Rules of Procedure, the discussion of the agenda will be the main priority. So, delegates are advised not to restrict their statements due to hesitation regarding procedure.

2. Foreign Policy: Following the foreign policy of one's country is the most important aspect of a Model UN conference. This is what essentially differentiates a Model UN from other debating formats. To violate one's **foreign policy** without adequate reason is one of the worst mistakes a delegate can make.

3. Role of the Executive Board: The **Executive Board** is appointed to facilitate debate. The committee shall decide the direction and flow of the debate. The delegates are the ones who constitute the committee and hence must be uninhibited while presenting their opinions/stances on any issue. However, the Executive Board may put forward questions and/or ask for clarifications at all points in time to further debate and test participants.

4. Nature of Source/Evidence: This Background Guide is meant solely for research purposes and must not be cited as evidence to substantiate statements made during the conference. Evidence for substantiating statements made during formal debate is acceptable from the following sources:

United Nations (Websites, Documents, Resolutions, Treaties, etc.) Government Reports (Can only be cited by the State that is ruled by the government in question. However, such reports can be considered invalid by other States) Reuters & Al Jazeera. State-operated News Agencies, Multilateral Organizations EU, ASEAN, NATO, etc.) NGOs recognized and collaborated with by the UN

Foreign Policy and Foreign Relations -

Foreign policy, in simple terms, is what your country aims to achieve regarding the issue at

hand or in general with its relations with other countries. Here are a few FAQs;

Q1. What role must foreign policy play in your research?

Understanding the foreign policy of your country must be a checkbox that you tick off at the very beginning of your research. Your foreign policy should dictate everything from the arguments you make, the reasoning you give for making those arguments, and the actions you take in the Council.

Q2. Where do I look to find a foreign policy?

Most of the time, foreign policy is not explicitly stated, It must be inferred from the actions and statements issued by the country, Reading the meeting records from previous meetings of the UNSC (or any other UN body where your country might have spoken on the issue) is a great place to start, If such records are unavailable, look for statements from your country's Foreign Ministry (or equivalent like Ministry of External Affairs, Ministry for Foreign Affairs, etc) and top leadership (PM, President , Secretary of State, Defense Minister). Foreign Relations on the other hand refers to the diplomatic ties that one country has with another and considers elements such as the mutual presence of embassies, consulates, and ambassadors & diplomatic dialogue, More often than not, foreign policy is what will be of your primary concern during your MUN but it is important to also consider any extremities in your allotted country's foreign relations.

Hierarchy of evidence -

Evidence can be presented from a wide variety of sources but not all sources are treated as equal, Here's the hierarchy in which evidence is categorized:

Tier 1: Includes any publication, statement, resolution, or document released by any of the Nation's official organs or committees. Any publication, statement, or document released by a UN member state in its own capacity. The evidence falling in this tier is considered the most reliable during the simulation.

Tier 2: Includes: Any news article published by any official media source that is owned and controlled by a UN member state, Eg.: Xinhua News (China) Bharti (India), BBC (United Kingdom) etcetera, The evidence falling in this tier is considered sufficiently reliable in case no other evidence from any Tier 1 source is available on that particular fact, event, or situation.

Tier 3: Includes: any publication from news sources of international repute such as Reuters, The New York Times, Agence-France Presse, etcetera. The evidence falling under this tier is considered the least reliable for the purposes of this simulation. Yet, if no better source is available in a certain scenario, it may be considered.

Mandate of the Commission

The Commission on the Status of Women (CSW), a functional commission of the United Nations Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC), is a global policy-making body dedicated exclusively to promoting gender equality and the empowerment of women. The Commission was established by ECOSOC resolution 11(II) of 21 June 1946 with a mandate to prepare recommendations on promoting women's rights in political, economic, civil, social and educational fields. The Commission is also responsible for monitoring, reviewing and appraising progress achieved and problems encountered in the implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action of 1995 and of the outcomes of the twenty-third special session of the General Assembly of 2000, at all levels, and to support gender mainstreaming. The Commission also contributes to the follow-up to the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development so as to accelerate the realization of gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls. Every year,

representatives of Member States, United Nations entities and non-governmental organizations in consultative status with ECOSOC gather at United Nations Headquarters in New York for the Commission's annual session. Usually held for ten days in March, the session provides an opportunity to review progress towards gender equality and the empowerment of women, identify challenges, set global standards and norms and formulate policies to promote gender equality and women's empowerment worldwide. The session is also a key opportunity for policy makers, advocates, researchers and activists to network and strategize, mobilize and plan new initiatives and actions to further the cause of gender equality and women's empowerment.

Programme of Work and Working Methods

The Commission's annual programme of work and its working methods are set out in relevant ECOSOC resolutions. The current working methods call for a thematic approach, and determine the inter-active nature of the session, the format of the outcomes and the participation of non- 3 governmental organizations (see ECOSOC resolution 2015/6). The Commission's multi-year programme of work for the period 2017-2019 is laid out in ECOSOC resolution 2016/3.

Documentation

The Commission will consider a number of reports prepared by UN Women, including a report on the priority theme and a report on progress made on the review theme at national level. Statements submitted by NGOs also form part of the documentation for the session. The following documents will become available on the CSW website at <http://www.unwomen.org/en/csw/csw61-2017> six weeks prior to the session:

- E/CN.6/2017/1: Provisional agenda and annotations
- E/CN.6/2017/1 /Add.1: Proposed organization of work

- E/CN.6/2017/2: Normative aspects of the work of the United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women (Report of the Under-Secretary-General/Executive Director of UN-Women)
- E/CN.6/2017/3: Women's economic empowerment in the changing world of work (Report of the Secretary-General)
- E/CN.6/2017/4: Challenges and achievements in the implementation of the Millennium Development Goals for women and girls (Report of the Secretary-General)
- E/CN.6/2017/5: Discussion guide for the Commission on the Status of Women ministerial segment on the priority theme (Note by the Secretariat)
- E/CN.6/2017/6: The situation of, and assistance to, Palestinian women (Report of the Secretary-General)
- E/CN.6/2017/7: Report of the United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women on the activities of the United Nations Trust Fund in Support of Actions to Eliminate Violence against Women
- E/CN.6/2017/8: Letter from the President of the Economic and Social Council to the Chair of the Commission on the Status of Women 5
- E/CN.6/2017/9: Input to the 2017 session of the Economic and Social Council and the High-Level Political Forum on Sustainable Development (Note by the Secretary-General)
- E/CN.6/2017/10: Results of the sessions of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women (Note by the Secretariat)
- E/CN.6/2017/NGO/1–131: Written statements submitted by nongovernmental organizations.

Output of the Commission

The principal output of the Commission on the Status of Women is the agreed conclusions on priority themes set for each year. Agreed conclusions contain an assessment of progress, as well as of gaps and challenges. In particular, they contain a set of concrete recommendations for action by Governments, intergovernmental bodies and other institutions, civil society actors and other relevant stakeholders, to be implemented at the international, national, regional and

local level. In addition to the agreed conclusions, the Commission also adopts a number of resolutions on a range of issues. One example is the situation of and assistance to Palestinian women. Another example is women, the girl child and HIV/AIDS. The annual report of the Commission is submitted to the Economic and Social Council for adoption.

NGO Participation

The active participation of non-governmental organizations (NGOs) is a critical element in the work of CSW. NGOs have been influential in shaping the current global policy framework on women's empowerment and gender equality: the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action. They continue to play an important role in holding international and national leaders accountable for the commitments they made in the Platform for Action. UN Women facilitates the participation of NGOs in sessions of CSW. NGOs that are accredited to and in good standing with ECOSOC may designate representatives to attend the annual sessions of CSW. The number of representatives who can attend open official meetings can be contingent on the availability of space.

Overview of the Agenda

Justice

The United Nations developed a body of international law, which is central to promoting economic and social development, as well as to advancing international peace and security. The international law is enshrined in conventions, treaties and standards. Many of the treaties brought about by the United Nations form the basis of the law that governs relations among nations. While the work of the UN in this area does not always receive attention, it has a daily impact on the lives of people everywhere.

The Charter of the United Nations specifically calls on the Organization to help in the settlement of international disputes by peaceful means, including arbitration

and judicial settlement (Article 33), and to encourage the progressive development of international law and its codification (Article 13).

Over the years, more than 560 multilateral treaties have been deposited with the UN Secretary-General. Many other treaties are deposited with governments or other entities. The treaties cover a broad range of subject matters such as human rights, disarmament and protection of the environment.

Rule Of Law

UN Women works to protect women's rights and enhance their security by supporting gender mainstreaming and strengthening gender-responsive rule of law institutions by advising on law and policy reforms, promoting access to justice for women and girls, and supporting accountability for conflict-related sexual and gender-based violence.

UN Women is an active member of the Global Focal Point (GFP) on Rule of Law and supports efforts to enhance knowledge and capacity to improve women's access to justice and security in conflict and post-conflict settings, and compliance with gender policies at the country level.

Transitional justice

Transitional justice is the range of mechanisms used to achieve redress for serious violations of international humanitarian law and international human rights law, often used in countries recovering from conflict or repressive regimes to address widespread abuse. Transitional justice mechanisms are key to re-establishing the rule of law.

Gender Justice Platform

Through the establishment of the Gender Justice Platform, UNDP and UN Women have joined forces to contribute to closing the global gender justice gap. The innovative and unique platform combines UN Women's gender equality expertise and UNDP's strategic rule of law programming experience, together with more than 20 partners to provide high-impact, sustainable programming that emphasizes women's leadership and intersectional approaches with international policy, advocacy, innovation and learning. Since 2020, the Gender Justice Platform has

enabled access to justice for 42000 individuals across 14 countries and territories across Africa and the Middle East

Legal Systems and Inclusivity

The rule of law is an important component of sustaining peace, as advanced by the General Assembly and Security Council in the twin resolutions on the review of the peacebuilding architecture. Sustaining peace requires an integrated and comprehensive approach across the UN system, based on coherence between political, security, development, human rights, gender equality and rule of law activities in support of Member State-led efforts. Women hold just 64 percent of the legal rights that men have. And in practice, even where equal treatment before the law is achieved, it does not always translate into fair outcomes for women. This leaves women unprotected, with consequences that extend across society.

Even today, girls across much of the world can legally marry before they turn 18. Across many legal systems, definitions of rape still rely on evidence of force or coercion rather than centring consent, leaving significant gaps in protection. More than 45 countries continue to have at least one legal provision that discriminates on the basis of sex such as denying women the right to confer nationality on a non-citizen spouse on the same terms as men. In 61 countries, at least one law restricts women from performing the same jobs as men.

Many legal frameworks continue to entrench justice, but laws policies and practices can be reshaped to meet the needs of women. They can strike down discriminatory rules, guarantee equal rights in both public and private life, and hold people accountable when women's rights are violated.

UNDP's Gender Justice and the Law initiative, in partnership with UN Women, UNFPA, and ESCWA helps track gaps in areas such as property rights, protection from violence, providing evidence and guidance to modernize outdated frameworks.

Handbook on gender - responsive law making (UN Women)

Equality in law is crucial to gender equality, as women and girls look to the laws of their State to protect, fulfill, and enforce their rights. Laws that discriminate and deny them equal rights with men and boys betray their trust in society and signal that gender discrimination is acceptable, normal, and expected. Women and girls left behind by discriminatory laws are often permanently excluded from the benefits of development. Conversely, the implementation of good laws that

conform to the human rights principles of equality and non-discrimination can help sustain efforts to move towards:

- just, peaceful, and inclusive societies;
- environmental and climate justice;
- equal participation in decision-making at all levels;
- universal access to essential public services; and
- economic prosperity for all.

All aspects of the law—constitutional, civil, criminal, labour, and administrative—that discriminate against women and girls need urgent attention. Repeal or revision of discriminatory laws is imperative, along with the work to enact and put into action laws that enhance existing legal protections and ensure backing by adequate resources.

Discriminatory Laws and Practices

Discriminatory laws against women are legal statutes or regulations that restrict women's rights, limit their opportunities, or treat them differently than men. These inequalities span the globe, severely impacting women's economic independence, bodily autonomy, and safety.

On 18 December 1979, the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women was adopted by the United Nations General Assembly. It entered into force as an international treaty on 3 September 1981 after the twentieth country had ratified it. By the tenth anniversary of the Convention in 1989, almost one hundred nations had agreed to be bound by its provisions. The Convention was the culmination of more than thirty years of work by the United Nations Commission on the Status of Women, a body established in 1946 to monitor the situation of women and to promote women's rights. The Commission's work has been instrumental in bringing to light all the areas in which women are denied equality with men. These efforts for the advancement of women have resulted in several declarations and conventions, of which the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women is the central and most comprehensive document.

The Working Group on discrimination against women and girls is one of the special procedures of the Human Rights Council. It was established on 1 October 2010 by the Council in its **resolution 15/23**, adopted by consensus. Most recently, the mandate was renewed in June 2025 through resolution **59/14**. It brings an independent and comprehensive approach to addressing discrimination against women and girls in all its forms. It engages with all States, irrespective of whether they have ratified the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women, and provides analysis and guidance on laws, policies and practices.

Shaping the law for women and girls: Experiences and lessons from UN Women's interventions (2015 – 2020)

Laws that discriminate against women and girls entrench gender inequality and are a major barrier to the realization of women's human rights. The most recent data available points to an estimated 3.7 billion women and girls currently living in countries where discriminatory laws are in place or key protections are lacking.

Important advances have been made in reforming constitutions and laws, yet gaps remain. While 192 constitutions guarantee equality and non-discrimination, 12 constitutions do not apply this guarantee in matters of adoption, marriage, divorce, and inheritance. In many countries legal protections have been put in place to secure gender equality in the workplace.

Major gaps persist in several fields such as in equality in parenthood as well as in efforts to address child marriage. Contrary to international commitments, the legal standard currently falls short of 18 years of age without exception for both men and women in 146 countries in 2021. More than 30 countries still lack laws prohibiting domestic violence, and an estimated 18 countries exempt perpetrators from prosecution from rape if they marry the survivor.

On the tenth anniversary of UN Women's establishment, this report brings together research and evidence from state and non-state actors to demonstrate how laws around the world treat women and girls, using trends since 2015 which highlight both gains and ongoing challenges. The report also shares UN Women's best practices and lessons learned in legal reforms with stakeholders within and outside the UN system, through diverse examples of interventions.

Structural barriers

In every country around the world women face multiple barriers and gender-based discrimination in the work place. The discrimination sets in early—from the kind of education girls get or till which age, to the kind of work they are channeled into. In both private and public spheres, women face occupational segregation, and multiple barriers such as -

- Lack of access to land
- Lack of access to capital,
- Lack of access to financial resources and technology
- Gender-based violence—due to cultural mindsets and stereotypes

. These obstacles make it harder for women to get on an equal footing with men in the world of work. Legal barriers further compound gender inequalities. Gender inequalities in social structures, based on institutionalized conceptions of gender differences. Conceptions of masculinity and femininity, expectations of women and men, judgements of women's and men's actions, prescribed rules about behaviour of women and men –all of these, and more, create and maintain gender inequality in social structures.

Context of UNCSW 70 - Official Session

First week

Monday, 9 March

10 am – 1 pm – Opening of the session and ministerial segment – General Assembly Hall

- Election of officers (Item 1)
- Adoption of the provisional agenda and other organizational matters (Item 2)
- Ministerial segment – Follow-up to the Fourth World Conference on Women and to the twenty-third special session of the General Assembly, entitled “Women 2000: Gender equality, development and peace for the twenty-first century” (Item 3)
 - Opening statements

- Introduction of reports
- Adoption of the draft agreed conclusions
- General discussion (Item 3)

3–6 pm – Ministerial segment (continued) – General Assembly Hall

- General discussion (Item 3) (continued)

Tuesday, 10 March

Ministerial segment (continued)

- **10 am – 1 pm** – Round table on the priority theme: Ensuring and strengthening access to justice for all women and girls, including by promoting inclusive and equitable legal systems, eliminating discriminatory laws, policies, and practices, and addressing structural barriers (Item 3 (a) (i)) – Conference Room 4
- **3–6 pm** – General discussion (Item 3) (continued) – General Assembly Hall

Wednesday, 11 March

Ministerial segment (continued)

- **10 am – 1 pm** – Round table on focus area: Achieving gender equality and the empowerment of all older women (Item 3 (a) (i)) – Conference Room 4
- **1 pm** – Deadline for submission of proposals under agenda Item 3 to the Secretariat
- **3–6 pm** – General discussion (Item 3) (continued) – General Assembly Hall

Thursday, 12 March

Ministerial segment (continued) – Conference Room 4

- **10 am – 1 pm** – High-level meeting – Violence against women and girls (Item 3 (a) (i))
 - High-level meeting – Violence against women and girls – Speaker bios

- **3–6 pm** – High-level meeting – Violence against women and girls (Item 3 (a) (i)) (continued)

Friday, 13 March

Ministerial segment (continued) – Conference Room 4

- **10 am – 1pm** – Voluntary presentations by Member States on the review theme: Women’s full and effective participation and decision making in public life, as well as the elimination of violence, for achieving gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls (Item 3 (a) (ii))
- **3–6 pm** – Voluntary presentations by Member States on the review theme: Women’s full and effective participation and decision making in public life, as well as the elimination of violence, for achieving gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls (Item 3 (a) (ii)) (continued)

Note: The Bureau recommends that the ministerial segment conclude on Friday, 13 March 2026, at 6 pm.

Second week

Monday, 16 March

- **10 am – 1 pm** – Interactive expert panel on the priority theme: Ensuring and strengthening access to justice for all women and girls, including by promoting inclusive and equitable legal systems, eliminating discriminatory laws, policies, and practices, and addressing structural barriers (Item 3 (a) (i)) – Conference Room 4
 - Interactive expert panel on the priority theme – Speaker bios
- **3–6 pm** – Interactive dialogue among youth representatives on the priority theme: Ensuring and strengthening access to justice for all women and girls, including by promoting inclusive and equitable legal systems, eliminating discriminatory laws, policies, and practices, and addressing structural barriers (Item 3 (a) (i)) – Conference Room 4
 - Interactive dialogue among youth representatives on the priority theme – Speaker bios

Tuesday, 17 March

- **10 am – 1 pm** – General discussion (Item 3) (resumed) – Conference Room 4
- **3–6 pm** – General discussion (Item 3) (continued) – Conference Room 4

Wednesday, 18 March

- **10 ~ 10.15 am** – Communications concerning the status of women (Item 4) – Consideration of the report of the Working Group on Communications on the Status of Women (closed meeting) – Conference Room 4
- **~10.15 am – 1pm** – General discussion (Item 3) (resumed) – Conference Room 4
- **3–6 pm** – General discussion (Item 3) (continuation and conclusion) – Conference Room 4

Thursday, 19 March

10 am – 1 pm – Conference Room 4

- Introduction of draft proposals (Item 3)
- Action on draft proposals (Item 3)
- Statements in connection with the draft agreed conclusions (Item 3)
- Follow-up to Economic and Social Council resolutions and decisions (Item 5)
- Action on any other outstanding issues
 - Provisional agenda for the seventy-first session of the Commission (Item 6)
 - Adoption of the report of the Commission on its seventieth session (Item 7)
- Closure of the seventieth session

Seventy-first session

- Opening of the seventy-first session of the Commission on the Status of Women

- Election of the Bureau of the seventy-first session

Context of UNCSW 70 - Official Documentation

Documentation

- Annotated provisional agenda and proposed organization of work (E/CN.6/2026/1)
- Proposed organization of work (E/CN.6/2026/1/ADD.1)
- Normative aspects of the work of the United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women: Report of the Under-Secretary-General/Executive Director of UN-Women (E/CN.6/2026/2)
- Ensuring and strengthening access to justice for all women and girls, including by promoting inclusive and equitable legal systems, eliminating discriminatory laws, policies and practices, and addressing structural barriers: Report of the Secretary-General (E/CN.6/2026/3)
- Review of the implementation of the agreed conclusions of the sixty-fifth session of the Commission on the Status of Women: Report of the Secretary-General (E/CN.6/2026/4)
- Discussion guide for the CSW ministerial segment: Note by the Secretariat (E/CN.6/2026/5)
- Women, the girl child and HIV and AIDS: Report of the Secretary-General (E/CN.6/2026/6)
- Report of the United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women on the activities of the United Nations Trust Fund in Support of Actions to Eliminate Violence against Women: Note by the Secretary-General (E/CN.6/2026/7)
- Results of the Pacific technical cooperation session and the ninety-first session of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women: Note by the Secretariat (E/CN.6/2026/8)

Chair's Summaries

The Chair of CSW issued summaries of meetings during the 70th session of the Commission on the Status of Women.

- Ministerial round table on “Access to justice for all women and girls: enablers and barriers” (E/CN.6/2026/9)
- Ministerial round table on “Achieving gender equality and the empowerment of all older women” (E/CN.6/2026/10)
- Women’s full and effective participation and decision-making in public life, as well as the elimination of violence, for achieving gender equality and the empowerment of all women and girls (agreed conclusions of the sixty-fifth session) (E/CN.6/2026/11)
- Expert panel on “Ensuring and strengthening access to justice for all women and girls, including by promoting inclusive and equitable legal systems, eliminating discriminatory laws, policies and practices, and addressing structural barriers” (E/CN.6/2026/12)
- Interactive dialogue among youth representatives on “Ensuring and strengthening access to justice for all women and girls, including by promoting inclusive and equitable legal systems, eliminating discriminatory laws, policies and practices, and addressing structural barriers” (E/CN.6/2026/13)

NGO statements

NGO statements are submitted by organizations in consultative status with the Economic and Social Council of the United Nations and are published without formal editing. The views expressed in these statements are those of the respective non-governmental organizations and do not necessarily represent those of the United Nations, UN Women, or the Commission.

- CEDAW Committee of Trinidad and Tobago, Federation of American Women’s Clubs Overseas (FAWCO), Fundación para Estudio e Investigación de la Mujer, Graduate Women International (GWI), International Center for Research on Women, Noble Delta Women for Peace and Development International, Red Dot

Foundation, Soka Gakkai International, and Soroptimist International
(E/CN.6/2026/NGO/1)

- Bahá'í International Community (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/2)
- Green and Better World (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/3)
- International Network for the Prevention of Elder Abuse (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/4)
- Priests for Life (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/5)
- Women's Health and Education Center (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/6)
- Association d'Aide à l'Education de l'Enfant Handicapé (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/7)
- Asociación Nacional Cívica Femenina (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/8)
- Corporación Mujeres Católicas por el Derecho a Decidir de Colombia and Católicas por el Derecho a Decidir (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/9)
- Fundación Red de Salud de las Mujeres Latinoamericanas y del Caribe (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/10)
- Fundacion Uriel IAP (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/11)
- Brazilian Association of Lesbians, Gays, Bissexuals, Transvestites, Transsexuals, and Intersex People (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/12)
- Association Nationale AL HIDN (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/13)
- Association of Families and Women in Rural Areas (AFAMMER) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/14)
- Catholics for Choice (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/15)
- Central Integrada de Apoio Familiar Pastor Rubens de Castro (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/16)
- Comparatively for Tanzania Elites Community Organizers (CTECO) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/17)
- Grae Matta Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/18)
- Handicap International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/19)
- Helpline Foundation for the Needy, Abuja (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/20)
- International Federation for Human Rights, Dr. Denis Mukwege Foundation and Equilibres & populations (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/21)
- La Verità Onlus - International Diplomacy (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/22)
- Legion of Good Will (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/23)
- the Maori Women's Welfare League Incorporated (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/24)
- Pacific Women's Watch (New Zealand) Inc (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/25)
- Passionists International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/26)
- Regards de femmes (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/27)

- Anglican Consultative Council, Church Women United, Domestic and Foreign Missionary Society of the Protestant Episcopal Church in the United States of America, Lutheran World Federation, Presbyterian Church (USA), Presbyterian Women in the Presbyterian Church (U.S.A.), Inc., Salvation Army, The, United Methodist Women, World Federation of Methodist and Uniting Church Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/28)
- Sustainable Development Council (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/29)
- WealthyGen, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/30)
- "Women and Modern World" Social Charitable Centre, (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/31)
- Women's Health and Education Center (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/32)
- Advocates for Human Rights (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/33)
- African Youth Movement (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/34)
- Asia Pacific Women's Watch (APWW) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/35)
- Association for Promoting Sustainability in Campuses and Communities (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/36)
- Centro UNESCO de Donostia - San Sebastián (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/37)
- Comisión para la Investigación de Malos Tratos a Mujeres (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/38)
- Comité de Vigilance pour la Démocratie en Tunisie (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/39)
- Federation of American Women's Clubs Overseas (FAWCO) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/40)
- Femmes solidaires (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/41)
- Fondazione Proclade Internazionale-Onlus (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/42)
- Fundación para Estudio e Investigación de la Mujer (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/43)
- International Psychoanalytical Association Trust (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/44)
- Madinaty and Réseau d'association de ma ville (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/45)
- National Women's Council of Catalonia - Consell Nacional de Dones de Catalunya (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/46)
- New Japan Women's Association (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/47)
- Organização das Mulheres Marítimas Africanas – WIMAFRICA (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/48)
- Slum Child Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/49)
- Women's Federation for World Peace International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/50)
- Women's Refugee Commission Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/51)

- Criminologists Without Borders Inc and World Society of Victimology (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/52)
- Northern Citizen Community Board (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/53)
- Alliance Creative Community Project (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/54)
- American Association of University Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/55)
- Campaign Life Coalition (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/56)
- CEDAW Committee of Trinidad and Tobago, Cashew Gardens Community Council, and Network of Non-Governmental Organisations of Trinidad and Tobago for the Advancement of Women, The (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/57)
- the Center for Justice and International Law (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/58)
- the Center for the Study of Crime (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/59)
- Centre Zagros pour les Droits de l'Homme (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/60)
- C-Fam, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/61)
- Committee of friends for humanity (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/62)
- Conectas Direitos Humanos (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/63)
- Endeavour Forum Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/64)
- AHAM Education Inc, Congregation of Our Lady of Charity of the Good Shepherd, Dominican Leadership Conference, Education for Social Justice Foundation, Feminist Majority Foundation, Girls Learn International, Inc (GLI), Global G.L.O.W., Grail, The, Greek Orthodox Archdiocesan Council of North and South America, Institute of the Blessed Virgin Mary - Loreto Generalate, International Council of Jewish Women, International Presentation Association, Loretto Community (Sisters of Loretto), Pan Pacific and South East Asia Women's Association, Passionists International, Religious of the Sacred Heart of Mary, Stella's Girls, Incorporated, Society of the Sacred Heart, US Women's Caucus, Inc., VIVAT International, WomenNC, NC Committee for CSW/CEDAW, and Zonta International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/65)
- the International Council of Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/66)
- International Women's Year Liaison Group (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/67)
- IPAS and MSI Reproductive Choices Ltd (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/68)
- Kebibetkache Women Development and Resource Centre (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/69)
- Make Mothers Matter (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/70)
- Makhzoumi Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/71)
- Mar Adentro de México A.C. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/72)
- Medical Women's International Association (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/73)

- Patient Access Network (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/74)
- Rose Academies Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/75)
- SANCSS Australia Ltd (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/76)
- SecurityWomen (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/77)
- Ten by Three (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/78)
- Women for Women's Human Rights - New Ways (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/79)
- Women's Global Network for Reproductive Rights (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/80)
- World Union of Small and Medium Enterprises (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/81)
- Ženska mreža Hrvatske (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/82)
- Zonta International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/83)
- African Cultural Promotions Inc, Association of Women Professional Financial Managers, Chibuzor Human Resource Development Organization, Civil Society Legislative Advocacy Centre, Divine Mercy Foundation for Helpless and Vulnerable Persons, Heal the Land Initiative in Nigeria, i-Smile International, Irene Menakaya School Onitsha, Law Explorer Development & Assistance Initiative, Leah Charity Foundation, Naval Officers' Wives Association of Nigeria, Tabernacle Worship and Prayer Ministry Inc., and Women and Child Watch Initiatives (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/84)
- Congregation of Our Lady of Charity of the Good Shepherd (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/85)
- Deutsches Komitee für UN Women e.V. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/86)
- Geledés - Instituto da Mulher Negra (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/87)
- International Federation of Business and Professional Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/88)
- International Federation of Consular Corps and Associations (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/89)
- International Network of Liberal Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/90)
- International Network of Liberal Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/91)
- Association of Iranian Jurists Defending Human Rights, Iranian Thalassemia Society, Payamavaran Hamyari (Chatra) and The Institute for Protection of Women's Rights (IPWR) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/92)
- Sociologists for Women in Society (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/93)
- Technical Centre for Fine Art and Computer Studies CIG (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/94)
- organization-name, Trinity Girls Network Corporation. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/95)
- Waterlight Save Initiative (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/96)

- Canadian Federation of University Women, Graduate Women International (GWI), and Women Graduates -USA, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/97)
- Women's International League for Peace and Freedom (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/98)
- WOMENVAI - Women and Men in Environment and Artificial Intelligence (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/99)
- Association for the Life of Africa-Liberia (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/100)
- Royal Commonwealth Society for the Blind (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/101)
- Center for Migration, Gender, and Justice (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/102)
- Centre for Women Studies and Intervention (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/103)
- CLAN (Caring & Living as Neighbours) Incorporated (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/104)
- End Child Prostitution, Child Pornography and Trafficking of Children for Sexual Purposes, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/105)
- End Female Genital Mutilation European Network, and Orchid Project Limited (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/106)
- Equality Now (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/107)
- Federation for Women and Family Planning (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/108)
- Global Organization for Sustainable Development Goals Inc (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/109)
- Haro Riksorg, Valfrihet Jämställdhet Föräld. Skap (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/110)
- Hellenic Association of Political Scientists and Kallipatira (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/111)
- Hunger Project, The (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/112)
- Instituto de Estudos Socioeconômicos (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/113)
- Instituto Dara (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/114)
- International Alliance of Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/115)
- International Federation for Family Development (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/116)
- Just Clean It Limited (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/117)
- Penal Reform International and The Vance Center (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/118)
- Rambhau Mhalgi Prabodhini (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/119)
- Brahma Kumaris World Spiritual University (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/120)
- Servas International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/121)
- Ucan Supurge Vakfi (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/122)
- Union Nationale des Femmes Marocaines (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/123)

- United Nations Association of the United States of America (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/124)
- Women's International League for Peace and Freedom (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/125)
- Women's Voices Now (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/126)
- ACT Alliance - Action by Churches Together, Christian Aid, Islamic Relief, Kirkon Ulkomaanavun Säätiö, Lutheran World Federation, and World Young Women's Christian Association (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/127)
- Ajoke Ayisat Afolabi Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/128)
- Asian-Pacific Resource and Research Centre for Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/129)
- Ballerina Management Institute (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/130)
- Canadian Federation of University Women (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/131)
- Center for Migration, Gender, and Justice (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/132)
- Equis: Justicia para las Mujeres (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/133)
- Fòs Feminista (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/134)
- Generation Initiative for Women and Youth Network (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/135)
- Graduate Women International, HelpAge International, Mother's Union, National Alliance of Women's Organizations, National Council of Women Great Britain and Northern Ireland, SecurityWomen, Soroptimist International, Soroptimist International Great Britain and Ireland, Wales Assembly of Women, Widows Rights International, Womankind Worldwide, Women's Platform (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/136)
- Ilitha Labantu (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/137)
- Congregation of Our Lady of Charity of the Good Shepherd, Grail, The, Institute of the Blessed Virgin Mary - Loreto Generalate, Society of Catholic Medical Missionaries, and VIVAT International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/138)
- International Relations Students' Association of McGill University (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/139)
- International Women's Development Agency (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/140)
- Best Practices Policy Project, Inc., Egale Canada, Federatie van Nederlandse Verenigingen tot Integratie Van Homoseksualiteit - COC Nederland, Global Action for Trans* Equality Inc., ILGA World, Outright International, Swedish Federation of Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual and Transgender Rights - RFSL (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/141)
- Nadam Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/142)
- NGO-Coordination post Beijing Switzerland (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/143)

- Nor Luyce Mentoring Center for Youth (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/144)
- OneNess Foundation for the Aged, Disabled and Children (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/145)
- Pan Pacific and South East Asia Women's Association (PPSEAWA) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/146)
- Presbyterian Church (USA) and Presbyterian Women in the Presbyterian Church (U.S.A), Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/147)
- Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/148)
- Sociedade Filantropica Maria de Nazare (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/149)
- Thorne Harbour Health (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/150)
- VAAGDHARA (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/151)
- Widows for Peace through Democracy and Widows Rights International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/152)
- Widows Rights International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/153)
- World Intangible Cultural Heritage Protection and Development Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/154)
- World Youth Alliance (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/155)
- Afrikanische Frauenorganisation, European Union of Women, Graduate Women International, International Association of Democratic Lawyers (IADL), International Council of Women, International Inner Wheel, Pax Romana (International Catholic Movement for Intellectual and Cultural Affairs and International Movement of Catholic Students), Soroptimist International, Verein zur Förderung der Völkerverständigung, Widows Rights International, World Union for Progressive Judaism, Zonta International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/156)
- Graduate Women International (GWI) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/157)
- International Justice Mission (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/158)
- International Police Association (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/159)
- Israel Women's Network (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/160)
- Mediators Beyond Borders International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/161)
- Equimundo Center for Masculinities and Social Justice, Let's Breakthrough, MenEngage Alliance, Rwanda Men's Resource Center, and Sonke Gender Justice (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/162)
- Netherlands Association for Women's Interests, Women's Work and Equal Citizenship (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/163)
- Soroptimist International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/164)

- South West Grid for Learning Trust (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/165)
- Women's World Banking (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/166)
- World Young Women's Christian Association (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/167)
- Al Najm (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/168)
- Best Practices Policy Project, Inc (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/169)
- Centre for Public Health (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/170)
- The FEMM Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/171)
- Fòs Feminista (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/172)
- Franciscans International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/173)
- Fundacja Instytut na rzecz Kultury Prawnej Ordo Iuris (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/174)
- International Federation of Social Workers (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/175)
- Education International, International Federation of Journalists, International Federation of Building and Wood Workers, International Trade Union Confederation, International Transport Workers' Federation, International Union of Food, Agricultural Hotel, Restaurant, Catering, Tobacco and Allied Workers' Associations, Public Services International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/176)
- Foro Internacional de Mujeres Indigenas (FIMI) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/177)
- Lutheran World Federation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/178)
- Nadam Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/179)
- Plataforma Portuguesa para os Direitos das Mulheres - Associação (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/180)
- Rajasthan Samgrah Kalyan Sansthan (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/181)
- Silver Lining for the Needy Initiative (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/182)
- Stevenson Holistic Care Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/183)
- Community Alliances for Drug Free Youth, Slum Child Foundation, Türkiye Yeşilay Cemiyeti (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/184)
- United Cities and Local Governments (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/185)
- Women's Board Educational Cooperation Society (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/186)
- Women for Water Partnership (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/187)
- Best Practices Policy Project, Inc (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/188)
- Centro Regional de Derechos Humanos y Justicia de Género (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/189)
- Associação de Jovens Engajamundo and Geledés - Instituto da Mulher Negra (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/190)
- La Manif Pour Tous (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/191)

- Virginia Gildersleeve International Fund, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/192)
- American Association of Jurists (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/193)
- Association Avocats Sans Frontière Humanitaires du Cameroun (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/194)
- Athletes United for Peace (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/195)
- Betneely Charity Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/196)
- Büro zur Umsetzung von Gleichbehandlung (BUG) e.V. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/197)
- CHIRAPAQ - Centro de Culturas Indígenas del Perú (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/198)
- Education for Social Justice Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/199)
- Fédération Européenne des Femmes Actives en Famille (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/200)
- HACEY's Health Initiative (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/201)
- Hadassah, The Women's Zionist Organization of America, Inc., American Jewish Committee, American Zionist Movement, Inc., B'nai B'rith, International Council of Jewish Women, Israel Women's Network, and World Jewish Congress (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/202)
- International Pharmaceutical Students' Federation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/203)
- International Planned Parenthood Federation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/204)
- Lehigh University (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/205)
- Liberian United Youth for Community Safety and Development (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/206)
- Mexican Federation of University Women (FEMU) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/207)
- Miss Caricom Int'l. Foundation CIP, INC (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/208)
- National Alliance of Women's Organizations (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/209)
- Plan International, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/210)
- Silver Lining for the Needy Initiative (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/211)
- Sisters of Mercy of the Americas (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/212)
- Stella's Girls, Inc. (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/213)
- Stevenson Holistic Care Foundation (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/214)
- The Women in Law and Development in Africa (T) (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/215)
- Casa Generalizia della Societa del Sacro Cuore, Company of the Daughters of Charity of St. Vincent de Paul, Congregation of Our Lady of Charity of the Good Shepherd, Congregation of the Mission, Congregations of St. Joseph, Dominican Leadership Conference, Edmund Rice International, Fondazione Proclade Internazionale-Onlus, Institute of the Blessed Virgin Mary-Loreto Generalate, International Presentation Association, Loretto Community (Sisters of Loretto),

Maryknoll Fathers and Brothers, Maryknoll Sisters of St. Dominic, Inc., Passionists International, Religious of the Sacred Heart of Mary, Salesian Missions, Inc., School Sisters of Notre Dame, Sisters of Charity Federation, Sisters of Notre Dame de Namur, Society of Catholic Medical Missionaries, UNANIMA International, VIVAT International (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/216)

- the Youth Coalition for Sexual and Reproductive Rights in consultative status with the Economic and Social Council (E/CN.6/2026/NGO/217)

Context of UNCSW 70 - Sessions Outcomes

The CSW70 session, held in New York from 9–19 March 2026, adopted agreed conclusions on the priority theme of ensuring and strengthening access to justice for all women and girls. The Commission reaffirmed its foundational commitments to the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action, CEDAW, the Convention on the Rights of the Child, and related international human rights instruments, while expressing deep concern at the persistent structural, legal, and socioeconomic barriers that prevent women and girls from accessing effective justice globally. Recognising that discriminatory laws, gender stereotypes, power imbalances, poverty, climate change, and the disproportionate impacts of conflict all compound one another, the Commission directed governments, UN entities, civil society, and the private sector to take fifty distinct urgent actions by 2030, spanning legal reform and the repeal of discriminatory provisions, institutional capacity-building and training of justice professionals, strengthened prevention and prosecution of gender-based violence, expansion of free legal aid and mobile or community-based justice services, regulation of artificial intelligence and digital platforms to prevent tech-facilitated abuse, and the development of disaggregated data systems including femicide registries. The conclusions also called for gender-responsive transitional justice in conflict and post-conflict settings, dedicated reparations funds for survivors, and gender-responsive budgeting to ensure adequate financing of the entire justice sector. Official development assistance and South-South cooperation were identified as essential for developing countries to meet these commitments, and UN-Women was specifically called upon to coordinate system-wide

implementation and support member states in accelerating progress toward the 2030 Agenda.

Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action

The Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action is a visionary agenda for the empowerment of women. It is also one of the reference frameworks to analyse the situation of women around the world and to assess the efforts of States in support of women's empowerment.

Adopted by consensus in 1995 following the mobilization of over 40,000 government delegates, experts and civil society representatives at the Fourth World Conference on Women, the Beijing Declaration and Platform of Action embodies the commitment of the international community to achieve gender equality and to provide better opportunities for women and girls. The platform of action responds to the collective effort of women and girls around the globe who have fought to achieve gender equality and women's rights and acts as a continuum of the international community's commitment to address civil, political, social, economic and cultural inequalities. It remains relevant today, affirming that women's rights are human rights and that equality between women and men benefits everyone.

The Platform of Action covers 12 critical areas of concern:



The Platform also sets an agenda for governments, international organizations, civil society and the private sector to safeguard women's human rights and to ensure that gender is taken into account in all national, regional and international policies and programmes.

Progress on implementation of the Beijing Platform for Action (BPFA) is reviewed by the Commission on the Status of Women (CSW) every five years. In this regard, and since the first review in 2000, the United Nations Regional Commissions, including the Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (ESCWA), have been mandated to prepare, in collaboration with regional organizations, regional reports on progress made towards the implementation of the BPFA. These reports are based on national reviews conducted by each of the United Nations member countries, and feed into a global report which is consolidated by the CSW Secretariat at UN Women and presented by the Secretary General to the General Assembly.

To date, five reviews have been conducted – in 2000, 2005, 2010, 2015 and 2020 – with each review resulting in an outcome document in which countries pledge to continue their efforts towards achieving global commitments relating to the rights of women and girls. The outcome document further outlines priority actions for the coming five years.

ESCWA has assumed a leading role to support countries in the Arab region in the Beijing Declaration and Platform of Action since the preparatory phase for the Fourth World Conference on Women. ESCWA continues to assist Arab countries to prepare for periodic national and regional reviews and in following up on regional and global recommendations arising from these reviews.

Further reading for Beijing Declaration -

https://www.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/Headquarters/Attachments/Sections/C/SW/PFA_E_Final_WEB.pdf

Case Studies

Case Study 1 — Ukraine: Justice Reform Under Active Conflict

Kateryna Levchenko, Commissioner for Gender Equality Policy of Ukraine, talked about how the government had endeavored to build back its trust in its justice system after the full-scale invasion in 2022. This includes adopting the Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court and the Istanbul Convention on violence against women, as well as signing a Framework of Cooperation between the UN on Conflict-Related Sexual Violence. These measures are considered vital "not only for delivering justice but also for building social cohesion and democratic legitimacy."

Structural Barrier identified: One of the major problems faced by people in situations of conflict is the justice gap, which means that over 60% of women are unable to fulfill their legal requirements. Over 676 million women today live within 50 kilometres of the threat of death due to conflict, the highest number ever registered.

Case Study 2 — Republic of Moldova

Among the few states within the same sub-region, which include Georgia and Ukraine, Moldova is part of those that have enacted gender equality laws to promote equal rights and protect against any form of discrimination, both direct and indirect, together with specific anti-discrimination laws and equality mechanisms responsible for handling complaints of discrimination.

But access to justice needs to go beyond the enactment of laws by addressing factors such as poverty and illiteracy that might hinder women from realizing their rights.

The representative of Moldova to CSW70 mentioned that Moldova has been ranked seventh among 148 states in the global gender gap index with an impressive 40% of women in parliament, confirming that "even a small country beset by several challenges can be bold and stand up for women, equality, and strong institutions."

Case Study 3 — Pacific Island States

The Pacific Island representatives at CSW 70 explained that geography acts as an added factor in the deprivation of justice in terms of the inability of women in isolated islands to access the courtrooms, law offices, and shelters. The unique structural barrier of geographic isolation is thus identified separately from law. Identified structural barrier: Geographic isolation and physical lack of access to formal legal facilities in dispersed populations, which can be solved by digital justice.

Case Study 4 — Brazil, Tunisia & Solomon Islands

Brazil, Belgium, Solomon Islands, Tunisia, and Ukraine – each representing one of the five United Nations Regional Groups – set the tone for discussions at CSW70 by offering key insights on comprehensive approaches to eliminating violence against women and girls. These include policy change and legal reform, investment in comprehensive national action plans, cross-sector collaboration, and overcoming challenges related to technology-based violence against women and conflict-related sexual violence.

Eighty-four nations offered their insights on their experience, emphasizing the importance of implementation, rather than the creation of new laws and policies, for success.

Structural obstacles highlighted during these sessions included:

- Social discrimination norms impeding reporting
- Legal aid services with insufficient resources
- Technology-based violence lacking legal recourse
- Gender-insensitive criminal justice processes

Case Study 5 — Haiti / Migrant Domestic Workers

The activists representing Haiti at CSW 70 revealed the exploitation of migrant domestic workers and stressed that if women's rights organizations were not funded, the victims would be deprived of the only channel for seeking justice. In this example, intersecting disadvantages like that of being migrants, working-class people, members of another race and having informal jobs lead to multiple exclusion from legal frameworks. The discriminatory law in relation to domestic work is directly causing structural injustice.

Suggested Moderated Caucus Topics

- Understanding factors leading to lack of access to justice
- Discussion on discriminatory laws and practices
- Root causes of structural barriers
- Solutions for more inclusive legal systems

QARMA (Questions A Resolution Must Answer)

- 1.** What specific mechanisms will Member States establish to identify and repeal discriminatory laws — including those governing marriage, divorce, property, and inheritance — within defined timelines, and how will compliance be monitored?
- 2.** How will the resolution ensure that access to legal aid is universally guaranteed for women and girls regardless of socioeconomic status, geographic location, or immigration status, and what funding models will sustain such systems?
- 3.** What measures will be adopted to formally integrate community justice workers and paralegals into national legal frameworks, and how will their work be standardised, resourced, and held accountable?
- 4.** How will the resolution address the acute justice gap faced by women and girls in conflict-affected and fragile states — where over 60% report unmet legal needs — including through transitional justice mechanisms that are gender-responsive and survivor-centred?
- 5.** What binding or recommendatory steps will Member States take to ensure that informal and customary justice systems do not perpetuate discriminatory norms, while remaining accessible to women in communities where formal systems are absent?
- 6.** How will the resolution tackle technology-facilitated violence against women — including online harassment, image-based abuse, and AI-enabled discrimination — and what legal remedies and enforcement mechanisms will be created for survivors?
- 7.** What institutional reforms within justice systems — including gender-balanced judicial appointments, mandatory gender-sensitivity training, and trauma-informed procedures — will the resolution require to prevent re-victimisation?
- 8.** How will the resolution address intersecting forms of discrimination faced by women who belong to multiple marginalized groups (indigenous women, women with disabilities, LGBTQ+ individuals, migrant women, incarcerated women), and what tailored protections will be put in place?

9. What concrete steps will Member States take to close the implementation gap between existing gender equality legislation and its enforcement in practice, particularly in contexts where institutional distrust and limited legal literacy remain structural barriers?

10. How will the resolution ensure sustained and adequate financing for women's rights organisations and civil society groups that serve as primary justice-access pathways for survivors, particularly in contexts where their funding is being actively restricted?

11. What geographic and infrastructural solutions — including mobile legal aid units, digital court access, and decentralised justice services — will the resolution propose to address the barrier of physical inaccessibility in rural and island communities?

12. How will accountability for perpetrators of violence against women and girls — including conflict-related sexual violence — be strengthened, and what mechanisms will ensure timely, affordable, and non-discriminatory access to legal recourse for survivors?

13. What role will the resolution assign to regional and international bodies, including the ICC, treaty bodies, and UN Women, in supporting Member States that lack domestic capacity to deliver gender-responsive justice?

14. How will the resolution address the structural economic barriers — poverty, financial dependence on abusers, lack of income — that prevent women from effectively accessing or sustaining engagement with legal systems, even where legal rights formally exist?

15. What review, reporting, and accountability framework will the resolution establish to track Member State progress on its commitments, and how will the voices of affected women and girls be incorporated into that monitoring process?

Further Readings

https://www.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/Headquarters/Attachments/Sections/C/SW/PFA_E_Final_WEB.pdf

<https://www.unwomen.org/en/how-we-work/commission-on-the-status-of-women/csw70-2026>

<https://www.unwomen.org/en/news-stories/speech/2026/01/csw70-for-all-women-and-girls-who-have-been-denied-justice>

<https://www.worldbank.org/en/topic/lawjusticeanddevelopment/brief/EWBL>

<https://www.unwomen.org/en/articles/explainer/what-justice-means-to-women-and-how-to-deliver-it>

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